OCUDU focuses specifically on the centralised unit (CU) and distributed unit (DU) layers of mobile network architecture. CU functions handle higher-level tasks such as traffic management, security policy enforcement, and operational automation across distributed infrastructure, including cloud services. DU functions manage lower-level real-time processes such as media access control and physical-layer operations, including modulation and data conversion across wired and wireless networks.

Integrating AI into these layers is expected to deliver higher network throughput, improved security, automation capabilities, and energy efficiency while opening new monetisation opportunities for telecom operators.

The open source initiative also aims to reduce dependence on proprietary AI stacks, particularly those dominated by NVIDIA, while promoting vendor diversity, competitive pricing, and large-scale deployment across telecom networks.

The OCUDU Ecosystem Foundation launched with 21 general members and 17 research institutions. Industry participants include AMD, AT&T, Cisco, Ericsson, Nokia and Nvidia.

By coordinating documentation, testing frameworks, and integration tools, the Linux Foundation aims to accelerate Open RAN adoption and foster the development of autonomous AI-driven telecom networks.

MWC26: Google Cloud, Mplify and partners showcase agentic AI-driven connected experiences

Mplify, alongside Colt Technology Services, Orange, Google Cloud and the GSMA Open Gateway initiative, demonstrated agentic AI-driven connected experiences at MWC26 Barcelona in March this year, using open, standardised network APIs to orchestrate connectivity across wireless and wired domains.

AI agents dynamically request quality on demand through CAMARA APIs, invoke Mplify Lifecycle Service Orchestration APIs, and coordinate mobile, fixed and cloud networks in real time. The approach supports connected vehicles, autonomous systems, and drones, enabling low-latency control, live video, telemetry and over-the-air updates. Google Cloud provides the AI infrastructure and multi-agent intelligence layer.

Automotive use cases come from DENSO and Tata Elxsi, validating predictable, performance-aware communications across domains.

“Connected experiences increasingly rely on on-demand NaaS for AI-driven networks that can reason, adapt, and act autonomously,” said Pascal Menezes, CTO, Mplify. “This demonstration shows how agentic AI and standardised CAMARA and Mplify LSO APIs work together to orchestrate communication quality across complex, multi-domain environments, delivering the predictable performance required for connected vehicles, drones, and the next generation of intelligent mobility.”

Henry Calvert, Head of Networks, GSMA, added, “CAMARA and Mplify provide the common, open source service and fulfillment API layer within the GSMA Open Gateway framework…”

China’s DeepSeek has more than 75 million downloads on Hugging Face

Chinese AI lab DeepSeek is turning open source momentum into hardware leverage, with more than 75 million downloads of its models on Hugging Face helping Chinese AI releases surpass every other country on the platform.

The scale of adoption is fuelling a new wave of Chinese open source systems competing directly with US labs and intensifying debate in Washington over exports of advanced AI processors to China.

Against that backdrop, DeepSeek has broken with industry norms ahead of its flagship V4 release. Instead of sharing pre-release access with long-time partners NVIDIA and Advanced Micro Devices for optimisation, the lab granted early access to domestic suppliers, including Huawei Technologies, giving Chinese chipmakers several weeks to tune software for local hardware.

AI developers typically collaborate closely with US chipmakers to ensure peak performance. DeepSeek itself previously worked with NVIDIA engineers, making the recent exclusion a notable departure.

Market impact appears limited for now. As Ben Bajarin, CEO of Creative Strategies, said: “The impact to NVIDIA and AMD for general data accelerators is minimal -- most enterprises are not running DeepSeek, which serves as a benchmarking model more than anything else.”

He added tools are cutting optimisation time “from months to weeks,” and the move may aim “to try to keep US hardware and models disadvantaged” in China.